F Mich 3 Grammar notes

How to say "in/to/from" + place name

- To say "*to/in*" a country, you **use "*en*" for feminine countries and "*au/x*" for masculine countries**. Generally, feminine countries end in the letter "-e".

je vais	*en France*	*en Écosse*
j'habite	*en Angleterre*	*en Italie*
	en Espagne	*en Australie*
	en Allemagne	*en Afrique (du sud)*
	en Autriche	*en Irlande (du nord)*
	en Belgique	

je vais	*au Pays de Galles*	*au Portugal*
	au Canada	*au Maroc*
	au Japon	*aux États-Unis*

- To say "*from*" a country, you **use "*de*" for feminine countries and "*du*" for masculine countries**, "*des*" if a plural country like USA.

je viens	*de France*	*d'Écosse*
une lettre	*d'Angleterre*	*des États-Unis*
	du Japon	*du Portugal*

- Towns have no gender. **To say "*in/to*" always use "*à*" to say "*from*" always use "*de*".**

je suis/vais	*à Windsor*	*à Paris*
une lettre	*de Lille*	*de Slough*

- **Some French towns have** *"Le/Les"* **in their name.** This will elide with any *"à"* or *"de"* to give *"au/x"* and *"du/des"*. *(Le Havre, Le Mans, Les Sables d'Olonne* etc*)*

je suis/vais	*au Havre*	*aux Sables d'Olonne*
une lettre	*du Havre*	*des Sables d'Olonne*

- To say "*to/in*" for **English counties**, use "*dans le*". For the **French départements**, use "*dans* + the relevant article *le/la/les*".

dans le Berkshire	*dans le Yorkshire*	*dans le Suffolk*
dans le Bas-Rhin	*dans la Loire*	*dans les Alpes-Maritimes*

- For (feminine*) **French regions**, *"in/to"* is translated by *"en"* and *"from"* by *"de"*.

en Provence	*de Provence*
en Normandie	*de Normandie*
en Bretagne	*de Bretagne*

*Masc. French regions use DANS LE:
Dans le Languedoc, dans le Dauphiné

-ER Verbs with present tense stem changes

- **ALL –ER verbs (except "aller") have the same endings in the present tense.**
  -e, -es, -e, -ons, -ez, -ent.

- **-GER verbs** need to preserve the soft "g" of the infinitive. If there is no "e/i" in the ending, then an "e" needs to be added to soften the otherwise hard "g". For the present tense, this means that "*nous*" forms only require an extra "e". The personal verb endings provide an "e" for other persons.

  - *je NAG e* *nous NAG **e** ons* *ils NAG ent*

  - *arranger, bouger, charger, corriger, déménager, déranger, encourager, exiger, héberger, juger, loger, longer, manger, mélanger, nager, négliger, obliger, partager, plonger, prolonger, ranger, rédiger, songer, soulager, voyager*

- **-CER verbs** need to preserve the soft "c" of the infinitive. These verbs achieve this by adding a cedilla accent to any "C" that is not followed by an "e/i". Again, this means the "*nous*" form only in the present tense

  - *je COMMENC e* *nous COMMEN Ç ons* *ils COMMENC ent*

  - *coincer, déplacer, divorcer, lancer, menacer, percer, placer, prononcer, recommencer, remplacer, renforcer, renoncer, tracer*

- **-YER verbs.** Here, the "y" changes to "i" in all people except "*nous/vous*"

  - *je netto i e* *nous netto y ons* *ils netto i ent*

  - *s'ennuyer, appuyer, employer, envoyer, essuyer, payer*, essayer*, balayer**
    **AYER verbs make these changes optionally. It's easier just to make them.*

- **-E/É-consonant-ER verbs.** The penultimate "e" will take a grave accent in all person except "*nous/vous*".

  - *j'ach è te* *nous ach e tons* *ils ach è tent*
  - *j'esp è re* *nous espér ons* *ils espè rent*

  - *accélérer, céder, compléter, considérer, espérer, exagérer, inquiéter, posséder, régler, répéter, révéler, suggérer, acheter, amener, emmener, enlever, geler, lever, mener, peser, promener, ramener*

- **APPELER, RAPPELER, JETER.** These verbs double the penultimate consonant of the infinitive in all persons except "*nous/vous*".

  - *j'appel l e* *nous appel ons* *ils appel l ent*